11-21 第1篇

阅读理解（议论文） Should Middle Schools Teach a Short Course on Everyday Money?

① On a cold Monday morning our maths teacher set the class a small puzzle: "You have 200 yuan in your bank account from last year's lucky-money; you earn 10 yuan each week for small house chores; one hoodie costs 149 yuan; a second-hand bicycle costs 380 yuan. How long do you need to wait before you can buy the bicycle, if you want to keep at least 50 yuan for an emergency?" Twenty seconds of silence. Then hands began to rise — slowly. Half of the class could not name **what a bank account actually is**. Two students admitted, quietly, that they had never held a 100-yuan note in their own hand. This small morning gave me one clear idea: **middle schools should teach a short, practical course on everyday money — just twelve lessons a year, carefully designed**.

② The first argument is simple: **we will meet money long before we meet most of our other school subjects in real life**. We probably will not use quadratic equations tomorrow, and many of us will not use advanced biology at university. But every student, almost from Grade 7 onwards, **handles money every week** — school lunch cards, mobile-phone recharges, small online gifts on app stores, paper envelopes at Chinese New Year, sometimes even helping a parent scan a QR code at the market. If a skill is this close to daily life, a school that ignores it is pretending the world does not exist.

③ The second argument is that **money is where small mistakes become big ones**. A student who does not understand how a "free trial" can **quietly become a monthly fee** on a parent's phone, can unknowingly waste 200 yuan in a year. A student who does not understand how **online gifts in game streams** work, can send a month of pocket money in a single evening. A student who does not understand the simple rule **"Interest is money that works for you — or against you"** can, five years later as a young worker, find herself paying the same debt twice. A twelve-lesson course cannot prevent every mistake; but it can make the most common ones much less likely.

④ Some people say, "Money is the parents' job." I respect this, but I disagree. In 2024, a city-wide poll of 1,800 middle-school families found that **only 37%** of parents had ever had a structured talk with their child about money — most families just mentioned it when something went wrong ("You should not have bought that"). Parents often want to teach, but feel unsure themselves. A clear, fair, **school course is not a replacement for family talks; it is a warm invitation to start them**. After each lesson, a small "home talk task" — such as "ask an adult family member about their first salary" — brings the school and the dinner table together.

⑤ Others worry, "A money course will turn children into small calculators; they will care too much about money." I understand this worry, but I think it misreads the course. A good everyday-money course is not about **getting more money**; it is about understanding **time, fairness, and care**. Its lessons include: *"A careful budget is a form of kindness to your future self." "A charity donation is also a money decision." "A loan from a friend still carries an invisible weight."* These are moral lessons with numbers; they do not narrow the heart — they widen it.

⑥ What should a good twelve-lesson course include? Here is my own modest draft: (1) **What is money, really** (barter, coins, notes, digital); (2) **Budget a school week** (a small paper spreadsheet, 45 min); (3) **The real cost of "free"** (trials, ads, attention); (4) **Wants vs needs** (with real photos from classmates, anonymous); (5) **Saving for a small goal** (four-month project, a real item under 400 yuan); (6) **Simple interest, simple inflation** (numbers kept small); (7) **Loans between friends** (the invisible weight); (8) **Online-shopping pauses** (the 24-hour rule); (9) **Scams that look friendly**; (10) **Giving well** (charity, family gifts, red envelopes); (11) **First part-time job, safely**; (12) **Talk with an adult you trust**. Twelve lessons. No hard exam. One simple **personal-budget diary** kept for two months.

⑦ A thoughtful worry remains: **"Will a money course make poorer students feel ashamed?"** This is a serious question. The answer lies in the teacher's design. No real family amount is ever asked aloud. All classroom examples use **fictional, clearly labelled** numbers ("imagine a family with 5,000 yuan a month"). Anonymous cards, not hands, are used for any survey. A good money course should make every student stronger; it should never make any family smaller. Done with care, it is one of the most equal lessons a school can give — because it gives the same tools to all, regardless of whose home the student goes back to in the evening.

⑧ Tomorrow, after the morning flag ceremony, I will bring the class's small proposal to the school office: *twelve lessons a year, no heavy exam, one teacher volunteering.* Even if the answer is a cautious "we will think about it," the conversation is already worth starting. Because — and this is the quiet point of the whole argument — **a school that sends us out into a world full of prices, choices, and quiet money decisions, and yet never spends twelve lessons on any of it, is like a school that teaches swimming only on dry land**. The pool is already here; we are already in it. The only honest question is whether the school will give us the small, simple tools to swim well.

注释： budget 预算；interest 利息；inflation 通货膨胀；scam 骗局；fictional 虚构的

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What made the writer think a short money course is necessary?

A. The teacher gave out free money.
B. A small Monday-morning maths puzzle about lucky-money, weekly chores, a hoodie and a second-hand bicycle showed that half of the class could not name what a bank account actually is, and two students had never held a 100-yuan note — this revealed how distant money knowledge is from students' daily vocabulary.
C. The school forced students to save.
D. The writer's parents gave her a lot of money.

2. Why does the writer say money meets us "long before most other school subjects"?

A. Because money is more important than all other subjects.
B. Because, unlike quadratic equations or advanced biology, money is handled every week from Grade 7 onwards — lunch cards, phone recharges, app-store gifts, red envelopes, scanning a QR code at the market — so a school that ignores money pretends the world does not exist.
C. Because schools must teach only money.
D. Because other subjects are easy.

3. What does the writer say about the parents' role?

A. Parents should teach everything; schools should stay out.
B. A 2024 city poll found that only 37% of parents had ever had a structured talk with their child about money; parents often want to teach but feel unsure themselves, so a school course is not a replacement for family talks but a warm invitation to start them — helped by small home-talk tasks after each lesson.
C. Parents should forbid any talk of money.
D. Parents should pay for the course.

4. According to the writer, what is the answer to the worry that a money course will turn children into "small calculators"?

A. The course is really about getting more money, so the worry is correct.
B. The course is not about getting more money; it is about time, fairness, and care — with moral lessons such as "a careful budget is kindness to your future self," "a charity donation is also a money decision," and "a loan from a friend still carries an invisible weight."
C. The course should be cancelled.
D. The course should teach gambling.

5. What does the writer mean by saying "a school that never spends twelve lessons on money is like a school that teaches swimming only on dry land"?

A. Swimming should replace money lessons.
B. Since students are already in a world full of prices, choices and quiet money decisions, a school that teaches nothing about it is giving a skill that is useless in real water; the honest question is whether the school will give students simple, equal tools to

swim well.
C. All schools should have swimming pools.
D. Water is dangerous.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第①段课堂故事
【解析】背景事件直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段核心论点
【解析】"贴近生活"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

3.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第④段统计 + 温柔邀请
【解析】直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑤段道德课定性
【解析】"时间、公平、关心"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

5.
【答案】B
【题型】推理判断题
【定位】第⑧段比喻
【解析】陆上学游泳比喻主旨。A、C、D 均偏离。故选 B。